

Deep Generative Models

Chapter 1: Text Generation via Language Models

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Transformer: *Revolutionary Sequence Models*

Transformer was proposed in 2017 in the paper

- *Attention is All You Need!*

providing a **computationally-efficient** way for sequence processing

Key Component of Transformers

Transformers use the **Attention** mechanism which enables *parallel processing* of *sequences*¹

We use the **Attention** mechanism in the sequel to *build context!*

¹Read more in *Chapter 7 of Applied Deep Learning* lecture notes

Key-Query-Value Tuple

Say we have the sequence of tokens

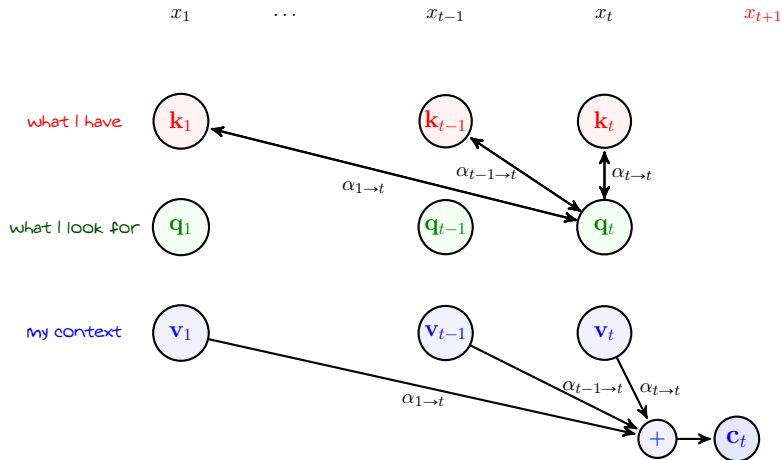
$$x_1, x_2, \dots, x_t$$

and intend to build **context** c_t to find the distribution of **next token** x_{t+1}

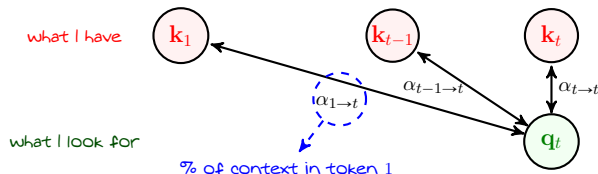
For each token in the sequence, we give three **separate embeddings**

- **Key** $\mathbf{k}_t \in \mathbb{R}^S$ which flags **what kind of context token** x_t **has to present**
 - **Query** $\mathbf{q}_t \in \mathbb{R}^S$ which flags **what kind of context token** x_t **is looking for**
 - **Value** $\mathbf{v}_t \in \mathbb{R}^S$ which embeds **the context of token** x_t
- + How do we compute these embeddings?
- No worries! We'll see shortly!

Building Context by Attention



Computing Attention Weights



We can compare the query with each key using *inner product*

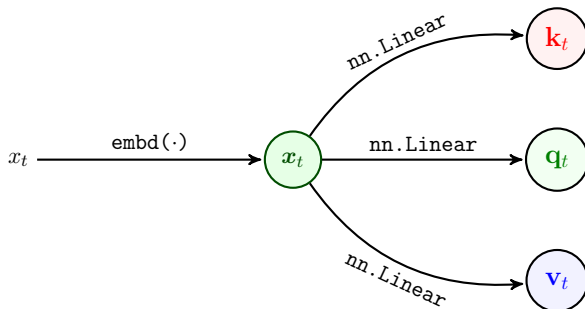
$$\xi_{j \rightarrow t} = \langle \mathbf{q}_t; \mathbf{k}_j \rangle$$

The larger $\xi_{j \rightarrow t}$ is, the more related tokens j and t are!

But, we need weights $\in [0, 1]$; so, we use *Softmax*

$$[\alpha_{j \rightarrow t} \text{ for } j = 1 : t] = \text{Soft}_{\max} (\langle \mathbf{q}_t; \mathbf{k}_j \rangle \text{ for } j = 1 : t)$$

Embedding Tokens: *Key, Query and Value*



We typically compute the tuples by *linear projections of token embedding*

$$\mathbf{k}_t = \mathbf{W}_k \mathbf{x}_t$$

$$\mathbf{q}_t = \mathbf{W}_q \mathbf{x}_t$$

$$\mathbf{v}_t = \mathbf{W}_v \mathbf{x}_t$$

for some $\mathbf{H}_k, \mathbf{W}_q, \mathbf{W}_v \in \mathbb{R}^{S \times E}$

Sequential Order

Say we have the following two sequences

$$x_{1:t} = x_1, x_2, x_3 \dots, x_t$$

$$\hat{x}_{1:t} = x_2, x_1, x_3 \dots, x_t$$

We have $k_i = W_k x_j$; thus, the keys see the same permutation

$$\hat{k}_{1:t} = k_2, k_1, k_3 \dots, k_t$$

If we compare with the query q_t , we get same permutation in weights

$$\hat{\alpha}_{1 \rightarrow t}, \hat{\alpha}_{2 \rightarrow t}, \hat{\alpha}_{3 \rightarrow t} \dots, \hat{\alpha}_{t \rightarrow t} = \alpha_{2 \rightarrow t}, \alpha_{1 \rightarrow t}, \alpha_{3 \rightarrow t} \dots, \alpha_{t \rightarrow t}$$

Sequential Order

Weights observe the same permutation as input

$$\hat{\alpha}_{1 \rightarrow t}, \hat{\alpha}_{2 \rightarrow t}, \hat{\alpha}_{3 \rightarrow t} \dots, \hat{\alpha}_{t \rightarrow t} = \alpha_{2 \rightarrow t}, \alpha_{1 \rightarrow t}, \alpha_{3 \rightarrow t} \dots, \alpha_{t \rightarrow t}$$

We have further $\mathbf{v}_i = \mathbf{W}_v x_j$; thus, the values also see the same permutation

$$\hat{\mathbf{v}}_{1:t} = \mathbf{v}_2, \mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_3 \dots, \mathbf{v}_t$$

So, the context of permuted sequence is

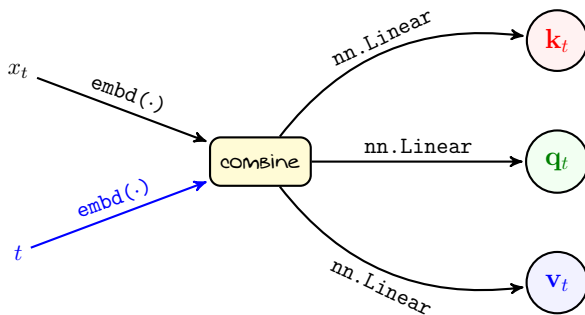
$$\begin{aligned} \hat{\mathbf{c}}_t &= \hat{\alpha}_{1 \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_2 + \hat{\alpha}_{2 \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_1 + \hat{\alpha}_{3 \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_3 + \dots + \hat{\alpha}_{t \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_t \\ &= \alpha_{2 \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_2 + \alpha_{1 \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_1 + \alpha_{3 \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_3 + \dots + \alpha_{t \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_t = \mathbf{c}_t \end{aligned}$$

Moral of Story

Using only token embedding we do not capture sequential order via attention!

Encoding Tokens with Sequential Order

We can capture sequential order by *positional encoding*

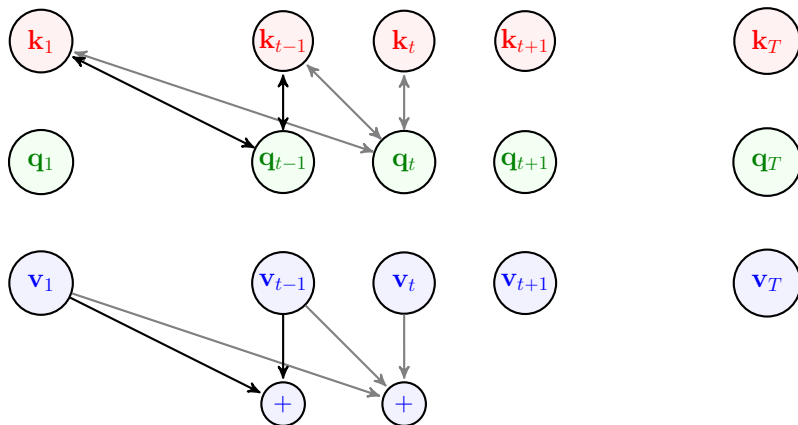


Classical combining approach is to add

$$x_t = \text{embd}(x_t) + \text{embd}(t)$$

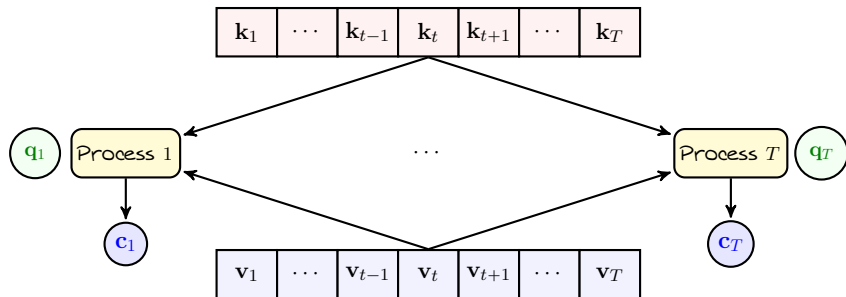
Parallel Context Computation

- + Do we still need to process **one token** at a time?
- No! The cool part is that we can compute all contexts **in parallel**



Parallel Context Computation

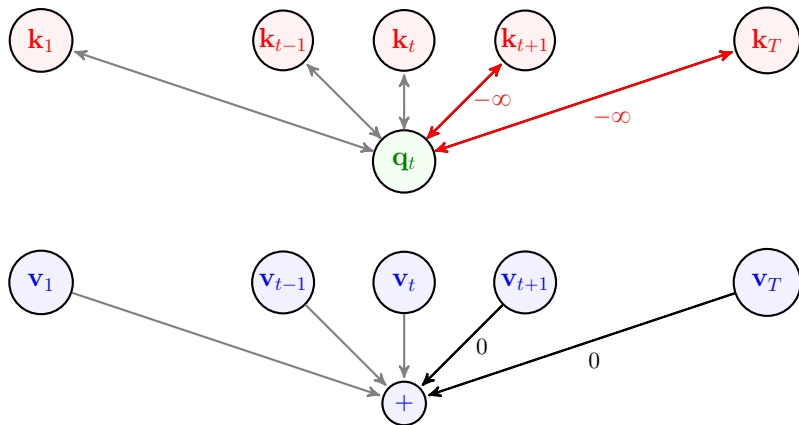
Indeed, we can break computation of $\mathbf{c}_1, \dots, \mathbf{c}_T$ into T parallel processes



- + But the number of weights in each process *differ*, right? Process 1 computes one coefficient, Process 2 computes two, $\dots$
- Yes! And, this can be easily unified 😊

Self-Attention with *Masked Decoding*

We can get query from *all keys* in the sequence and rewrite them to keep the weights zero for future tokens $\rightsquigarrow$ *replace future inner-products with $-\infty$*



Masked Decoding

- + Why do we replace the inner products with $-\infty$?
- To make the corresponding Softmax output **zero**

By setting $\exp \{ \xi_{j \rightarrow t} \} = -\infty$ for $j > t$, we have

$$\alpha_{j \rightarrow t} = \frac{\exp \{ \xi_{j \rightarrow t} \}}{\sum_{i=1}^T \exp \{ \xi_{i \rightarrow t} \}} = \frac{\exp \{ -\infty \}}{\sum_{i=1}^T \exp \{ \xi_{i \rightarrow t} \}} = 0$$

- + Why do we call it **masked** decoding?
- Well! If we wanted future tokens impact the current one
 - ↳ we did not need to mask out $\exp \{ \xi_{j \rightarrow t} \}$ for $j > t$
 - ↳ this is used **encoding**, e.g., for translation machine

Self-Attention: *Single Head*

SA_Head($x_{1:T}$:input_seq):

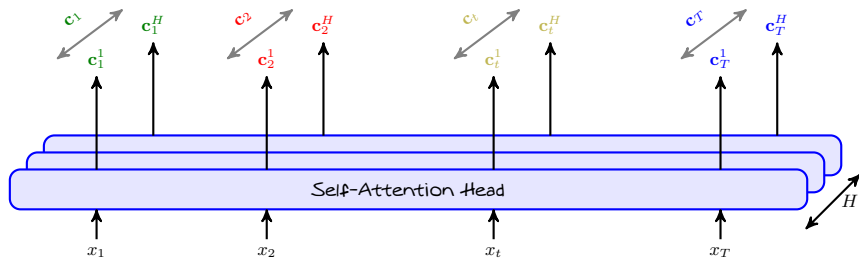
```

1: for  $t = 1 : T$  do
2:   Set  $\mathbf{x}_t \leftarrow \text{embd}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \text{embd}(t)$                                 #positional enc
3:    $\mathbf{k}_t, \mathbf{q}_t, \mathbf{v}_t \leftarrow \text{Linear}(\mathbf{x}_t), \text{Linear}(\mathbf{x}_t), \text{Linear}(\mathbf{x}_t)$ 
4:    $\xi_{1:T \rightarrow t} = \langle \mathbf{k}_1; \mathbf{q}_t \rangle, \dots, \langle \mathbf{k}_T; \mathbf{q}_t \rangle$                 #query  $\times$  keys
5:   if masked_decode = True then
6:      $\xi_{t+1:T \rightarrow t} = -\infty$ 
7:   end if
8:    $\alpha_{1:T \rightarrow t} = \text{Soft}_{\max}(\xi_{1:T \rightarrow t})$                                 #attention weights
9:    $\mathbf{c}_t \leftarrow \sum_i \alpha_{i \rightarrow t} \mathbf{v}_i$                                 #build context
10: end for
11: return  $\mathbf{c}_t$  for  $t = 1 : T$ 

```

- + Why calling it a *Head*?
- Well! In practice we can apply multiple of these heads *in parallel* to make a *richer context*

Self-Attention: *Multi-Head*



Head Size

We typically set the size of context in each head such that the concatenated context is of embedding size, i.e.,

$$\mathbf{c}_t \updownarrow E \rightsquigarrow \mathbf{c}_t^h \updownarrow \frac{E}{H}$$

Self-Attention: *Multi-Head*

```
SelfAttention( $x_{1:T}$ :input_seq,  $H$ :# of heads):  
1: for  $h = 1 : H$  do  
2:   Compute  $\mathbf{c}_{1:T}^h \leftarrow \text{SA\_Head}(x_{1:T})$  #independent heads  
3: end for  
4: Set  $\mathbf{c}_t \leftarrow [\mathbf{c}_t^1, \dots, \mathbf{c}_t^H]$   
5: return  $\mathbf{c}_t$  for  $t = 1 : T$ 
```

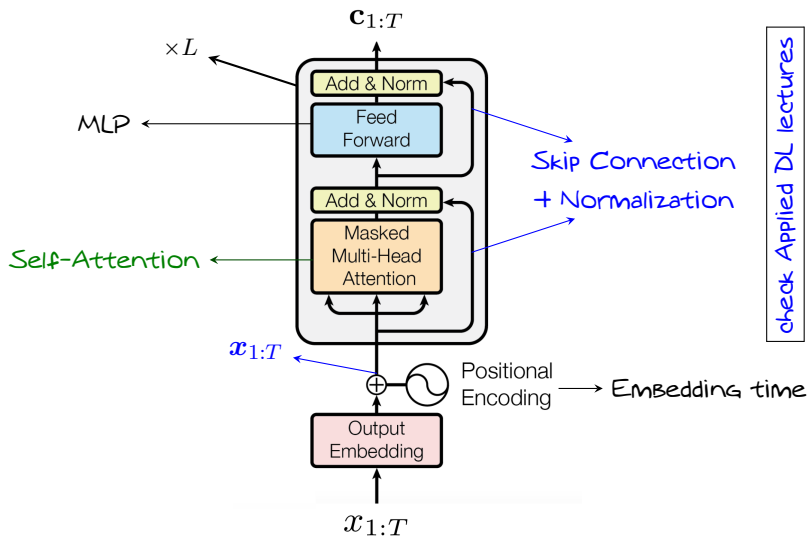
- + Is this then a *Transformer*?
- A **shallow** one! We can make it **deep** with L layers!

Transformer-Based LM: Context Extractor

```
TransformerDec( $x_{1:T}$ ,  $H$ :# of heads,  $L$ :depth):  
1: for  $\ell = 1 : L$  do  
2:    $c_{1:T} \leftarrow \text{SelfAttention}(x_{1:T}, H)$   
3:    $c_t \leftarrow \text{MLP}(c_t)$  for  $t = 1 : T$  #extra computation  
4: end for  
5: return  $c_t$  for  $t = 1 : T$ 
```

- + What does the **MLP** do?
 - It makes **more complexity** to the model
 - ↳ This **increases** the **model capacity**
 - ↳ It can hence **enhance** the **learning capability** of the model
- + Good that we talk again **"computational"**! 😊
- We need to switch to **"statistical"** talks pretty soon 😊

Transformer-Based LM: Overview



Transformer-based LM: Context Extractor

- + Wait a moment! We have not computed the *distribution*!
- We can readily do it by a **final MLP**

```
TransformerLM( $x_{1:T}$ ,  $H$ :# of heads,  $L$ :depth):
```

```
1:  $c_{1:T} \leftarrow \text{TransformerDec}(x_{1:T}, H, L)$ 
```

```
2: for  $t = 1 : T$  do
```

```
3:    $p_{t+1} \leftarrow \text{MLP}(c_t)$ 
```

$\#p_{t+1} \in [0, 1]^I$

```
4: end for
```

```
5: return  $p_{t+1}$  for  $t = 1 : T$ 
```

Training Transformer-based LM

It's good to imagine how we can train this model

```
TransformerLM_Train(D:train_set):
1: for multiple epochs do
2:   Sample a batch  $\mathbb{B} = \{(x_{1:T+1})_b\}$  #samples of  $T$  tokens
3:   for  $b = 1 : B$  do
4:      $\mathbf{p}_{2:T+1,b} \leftarrow \text{TransformerLM}(x_{1:T,b}, H, L)$ 
5:     Compute  $\nabla_b \leftarrow -\sum \nabla \log \mathbf{p}_{t+1,b}[x_{t+1,b}]$  #seq LL grad
6:   end for
7:   Update  $\mathbf{w} \leftarrow \mathbf{w} - \eta \text{opt\_avg}\{\nabla_b\}$  #average batch
8: end for
```

Important

Training loop in this case can be *extensively parallelized!*

Generation via Transformer-based LMs

It's good to think how a this LM generates the whole new text

```

TransformerLM_Generation( $x_{1:t}$ :input_text):
1: for  $i = t : T - 1$  do
2:    $x_{1:T+1} = x_{1:i}, 0, \dots, 0$                                 #add  $\emptyset : 0$ 
3:    $\mathbf{p}_{2:T+1} \leftarrow \text{TransformerLM}(x_{1:T-1}, H, L)$       #masked decode
4:    $x_{i+1} \leftarrow \text{multinomial}(\mathbf{p}_{i+1}, \text{\#smp1}=1)$           #sample next token
5: end for
6: return {token[ $x_t$ ] for  $t = 1 : T$ }                                #completed text

```

In practice though, we can improve computational efficiency by

- We can **drop** number of key and query computations by **caching**
- We compute **only** the **target token distribution** in each iteration
- ...

Ready for LLMs!

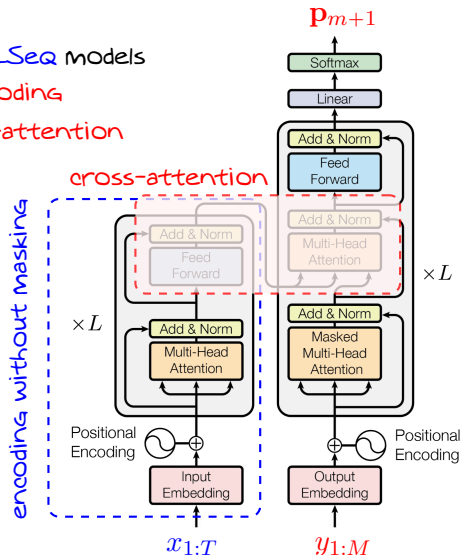
- + *Is this then an LLM?*
- Well! If scale it **crazy** up, Yes!
- + *How **crazy** should we **scale**?*
- **Pretty crazy!** 😊
- + *But, isn't this simply a **text completer**? How does it do what **ChatGPT** does?*
- Well! This is what we call “Pre-trained LLM”; we need to do some **few extra steps** to get there
- + *What are those steps?*
- No worries! We have the next section **dedicated to LLMs**

Final Note on Transformers

Transformers are **Seq2Seq** models

↳ our LM uses only **decoding**

↳ we don't need **cross-attention**



check Chapter 7 of Applied DL lectures